A-A-50215A
February 11, 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50215
September 14, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLANIMETER, POLAR, COMPENSATING, WITH CASE

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-P-20664.

This commercial item description covers Planimeters, Polar, Compensating, used for measuring areas of a plane figure by tracing or optically observing its boundary lines.

Salient Characteristics:

Design: The planimeter shall be of the compensating polar type. The planimeter shall consist of two principal parts:

a. The tracer arm which carries the tracing point and recording carriage with measuring wheel. The arm shall be graduated for an effective length of not less than 6 inches to enable setting the recording carriage vernier to hundredths at any scale within the range of the instrument. The tracer needle shall have an adjustable point, and be provided with a fingertip guider at the outer end of the tracer arm.

b. The pole arm shall be adjustable from approximately 6 inches to 13 inches and have an engraved scale and vernier for settings when the instrument is used with the pole inside a figure. The instrument constant can be adjusted to a round number for any setting of the recording carriage.

Graduation: The graduations on the tracer arm and pole arm shall be machine divided and shall be spaced not more than 0.5 millimeter (mm) when the metric system is used, or 0.025 inch when the decimal inch system is used.

Area Coverage: The planimeter shall measure the area within a circle having a 16 inch radius when the pole is within the circle and shall measure the area of a circle 12 inches in diameter when the pole is outside the circle.

Testing Rule: A metal testing rule shall be furnished with each planimeter.

AMSC N/A FSC 6675

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Graphs: Two graphs shall be provided, one for square inches and one for square centimeters.

Case: The planimeter shall be furnished in a fitted case for protection. The case shall have a hinged cover and a fastener.

Accuracy: The instrument shall check the area engraved on the testing rule and vernier units indicated on the graphs within 1.0 percent.

Material: Corrosion resisting metal.

Literature: The planimeter shall include the standard commercial operating instructions and parts list.

Part number. The document part number for the planimeter polar compensating shall be as follows:

AA50215 - 1

- AA50215 — CID identifier.
- 1 — Dash number for this item.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Packaging and marking. Military packaging shall be specified when shipments are to overseas Department of Defense (DoD) consignees. Commercial packaging may be specified for shipments to DoD consignees within the Continental United States and to non-DoD consignees worldwide. When a supplier's normal packaging will satisfy the requirements for military packaging, it may be used.

Military packaging. Each planimeter in its case shall be preserved and packed to protect against physical damage and deterioration in a logistic environment characterized by the following:

1. Multiple handling during transportation and in-transit storage.
2. Shock, vibration, and static loading forces during worldwide shipment by all transport modes.
3. Uncontrolled warehouse storage for extended periods.
4. Weather exposure during shipment and in-transit transfers.
5. Stacking loads during shipment and storage.

Quantities of planimeters in cases destined to a single addressee may be unitized into one or more unit loads.

Commercial. Each planimeter in its case shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's normal method for retail distribution. Planimeters shipped to a single destination may be unitized to permit handling as a single unit. Shipping containers shall comply with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Marking. Unit, intermediate (when provided), and exterior packs shall be marked with the item nomenclature, stock or part number, quantity per pack, and contract number as a minimum; additional marking shall be as specified in the contract or order. Exterior packs shall have in addition the complete consignee's address. Markings shall be applied in a legible manner, in a contrasting color, of an appropriate size, and of waterproof materials.

Quality assurance. Each planimeter and case shall be examined for the following defects. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

1. Material not as specified.
2. Design not as specified.
3. Graduations or accuracy not as specified.
4. Area coverage not as specified.
5. Testing rule, graphs, case, or literature not provided as specified.
6. Packaging and marking not as specified.

Certification of commercial item. The contractor shall furnish certification for Government approval that the product offered to the Government meets the salient characteristics of this description and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and is the same product as the manufacturer's current product offered by the contractor in the commercial marketplace for at least one year preceding the solicitation. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Small business. A small business that cannot meet the certification-of-commercial-item requirement of this document, may make an offer under this solicitation; and, if such small business is the apparent successful offeror, the Government may require the small business to submit a sample planimeter. Any such polar compensating planimeter may be evaluated for this solicitation if time to contract award permits. Such evaluation would be to determine conformance to all requirements of this commercial item description and to determine equivalency to planimeters available in the commercial marketplace in the areas of durability, human factors engineering, and safety. It should be noted that samples are not required unless specifically requested by the contracting officer. Note. The Government may elect not to evaluate a sample from an apparent low offerer for award for this solicitation if a determination of urgency is made by the contracting officer. The sample would then be evaluated prior to future solicitation for comparable items.

Note: When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T08:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Custodians

Army - ME

Review activity

DLA - GS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA - FCGC

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - ME

Project 6675-0815

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.